



STEPHEN HAWKING

British theoretical physicist
1942–2018

Stephen Hawking used his brilliant brain to explore space and time, and he helped millions of people to understand the universe better. For most of his life, Stephen lived with a condition called motor neurone disease. This slowly stopped his body from working. But, no matter how challenging life became, Stephen kept asking questions and seeking answers as a theoretical physicist.

Stephen didn't conduct experiments or peer through telescopes. Instead, he explored the universe in his mind and tried to describe it using mathematics. This allowed Stephen to make predictions about things that no one had ever seen, such as black holes.



Stephen (in white) studied at both the University of Oxford and the University of Cambridge, in the UK.



Stephen's biggest adventure was a parabolic flight, which let him experience microgravity (weightlessness).